

A HOW-TO GUIDE

HACK THE AIRBNB ALGORITHM



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INTRODUCTION

Hello, I'm your coach LILIAN KOSKEI.

I have hosted guests in the Airbnb space for over 5 years now and my joy is having guests coming in to my place and enjoying their stay, some of them having to come back to my place every time they are coming into my country Kenya. I have had so many hosts getting into the Airbnb space and end up not doing so well, getting disappointed and end up quitting but I believe with the right guidance every one can thrive in this space hence the thought of coming up with this guide came up. So buckle up and stay with me for this ride through my guidance and experience a huge difference in your hosting. Cheers to happy hosting.

- Lilian Koskei



CHAPTER 1

Calendar Management

Never Ever block off your Airbnb calendar at any one point in time as long as you still intend to continue hosting on the Airbnb app.

This is also applicable when you have other bookings from other sites or have offline bookings. When you do this, the algorithm assumes that you are not a serious business owner and it will push your listing down in the search engine of properties around your area. It will then boost those properties with unblocked calendars on top of the search listing.

What you can do instead is increase the price for those unavailable dates significantly, for instance if you charge your property 50\$ per night, you can edit the price to be 500\$ per night. This will ensure that your property is still visible in the booking site as opposed to when you completely block off the dates.

CHAPTER 2

Location, Location, Location

I have emphasized on this because the location where you set up your Airbnb business should be very strategic to ensure a continuous flow of bookings all through the year. Set up your units in areas close to companies (office spaces), the CBD as well as areas close to recreational facilities. These areas will give you guests who are both coming for business into the country as well as those looking to come for leisure purposes. So look for locations close to parks, nature trails, malls, supermarkets, hospitals, good schools and also areas accessible to night life facilities for those after work unwinding sessions.

Also ensure that the unit is in a peaceful, quiet and calm area where the guests can have their work meetings and calls with minimal background noise

CHAPTER 3

Instant Book

Always have the instant book feature activated in all the listings you may have. The properties that are on instant book are usually boosted to be on top of the search engine for areas because it enables a quick and easy booking process for both guests as well as the hosts because when the guest immediately books, the booking goes through immediately as there are no waiting periods for the host to approve the booking as in those properties with no instant book feature activated on their listings.



CHAPTER 4

Superhost Status

Strive to achieve this status on the first quarter of hosting and maintain it through the year. This is because the algorithm for Airbnb always puts all the Superhosts' units on the first page search results for areas that the guest would want to book. Say, all the superhosts in westlands - their units are usually on page 1 when guests search for areas around Westlands and then all the others who aren't superhosts come after them.



CHAPTER 5

Discounts

Take advantage of the discounts offered in the promotional page. For instance the 20% off per night gives email alerts to guests, gives you the strike button on the original price. New listing promotion of 20% offered to new hosts for the first 3 bookings. All these will lead to favor from the algorithm which increases the visibility of your units hence increase in bookings. You can also take advantage of monthly discounts, weekly discounts as well as the short trips discounts



CHAPTER 6

ASK FOR POSITIVE REVIEWS

Always ask the guest for a positive 5* review after they check out of your unit. This can be done by setting up the automated message of requesting for a 5* review rating that is set to get to the guest say 5 to 6 hours after they check out on same day of the check out.

The reviews will boost your business as potential guests before booking will read through reviews, the more the reviews, the more confident they are that the property is available as opposed with those properties with zero reviews. This leads to a high increase in bookings hence property being pushed up by the algorithm.

The reviews will also help you the host improve the service offering as guests will also point out what went wrong and what needs improving.



CHAPTER 7

Professionally Taken Photos

Ensure that the photos are taken by a professional, preferably have the Airbnb team take the professional photos once you list your property. They have that option to request for photography at a fee which will be deducted from the subsequent payouts from the future bookings. The algorithm definitely boosts the units with professionally well taken beautiful photos

CHAPTER 8

Prompt Response

Always ensure that the guests inquiries are responded to quickly. The algorithm definitely favors properties whose hosts respond quickly preferably in under 1 hour or so.

CHAPTER 9

Self Check In

Ensure that the guest can check in on their own at whatever time even after past the check in times. This can be done by installing a lockbox or having a smart lock. This is beautiful and convenient for both the host and the guest as they can check in whatever time they would like without you as the host needing to be present



CHAPTER 10

Guest Cancellation

Avoid cancelling the guests reservations unless you cannot really 100% fully host the guest due to unavoidable circumstances. There is a 50\$ cancellation fee with no valid explanation plus when you cancel the algorithm sees that your unit is not reliable to host guests hence pushes your listing down the search options

CHAPTER 11

Cleanliness

Always always maintain cleanliness of the highest level possible as this will give you positive reviews which will then translate to increase bookings which will then translate to algorithm working in your favor and have your listing up in the search options for properties in your area. Ensure that the items that are not for cleaning on a daily basis are done at least once or twice a month e.g curtains for the house. Curtains tend to carry a lot of dust and absorbs smells from cooked food, cigarettes which will then prevent the house from smelling fresh even though the rest of the house is cleaned well.



CHAPTER 12

Setting Up Automated Messages

Set up automated messages for check in and check out directions for the guest immediately the guest books. This automated messages set up settings is in the Airbnb back office. This ensures a smooth check in process and check out process where even if you as the host are not available next to the phone, the guest can check in and out seamlessly. Some of the check in and check out messages you can come up with include:

a) Guest Welcome Message

Name, welcome thank you for booking with us, we are thrilled to host you. Our check in time is from 1pm, at what time will you be checking in?

b) Map to the apartment/house

Here is the google map to the apartment/house(paste the google map address here giving them the floor/ house number also giving a contact number to reach you incase they need anything

c) Wifi Details

Here are the wifi details:

Username: Namani123

Password: Namani XY123

d) Welcome Message/Experience Message

This is sent to check up on the guest after they have checked in asking if all is okay and if they need anything. Set this up to get to them at around 10pm of the night of check in.

e) Check Out Message Reminder

e.g This is a reminder that your check out is tomorrow 18th Nov 2025 at 10.00am or before that. Let us know what we can do to offer you a seamless check out process.

f) Check Out Instruction

Remind the guest to switch off all the lights, return the keys into the lockbox if you use a key and any other check out instruction that you may have.

g) Positive Review Request

On the day of check out say 5 hours later after their check out requesting for a 5* review as follows: It was our wonderful privilege to host you. we were thrilled to be your host. we value you and appreciate you. we hope you enjoyed your stay with us.

(Guest Name) Kindly take a minute and give us a 5* rating on your review so that we can keep on serving you in the days to come. Be sure we will also give you a 5* star rating review on your stay because you have been a wonderful guest to us.

Have a safe journey and enjoy your day

(automated message)

CHAPTER 13

Conclusion

Congratulations for sticking with me till the end. It is so easy to hack the Airbnb algorithm with the steps shared above. Try it and come back to me with feedback that your bookings hence your revenue increased significantly with these simple steps.

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